

How Much to Check

AI can help with almost any task. The real skill is knowing how much to check what it gives you. Some answers need a hard look. Others barely need one.

That’s what trust really comes down to here. Not believing the output automatically, but knowing what kind of follow-up it needs before you use it.

SOMETIMES THE ANSWER IS NO

Before the dial even matters, there’s a faster call. Some moments shouldn’t go to AI at all: the sharpest move is to leave the tool closed and handle it yourself, or hand it to a real person.

DON’T REACH FOR IT WHEN

THE RULE ALREADY SAYS NO

- The assignment or policy forbids it.
- You’d be using it to dodge the very skill you’re there to build.

IT INVOLVES PRIVATE INFORMATION

- You’d have to paste your own sensitive details.
- It means handing over someone else’s private information.

YOU CAN’T STAND BEHIND THE RESULT

- You can’t verify whether the output is true.
- It’s a high-stakes call that needs a qualified human.
- It would act under your name without your review.

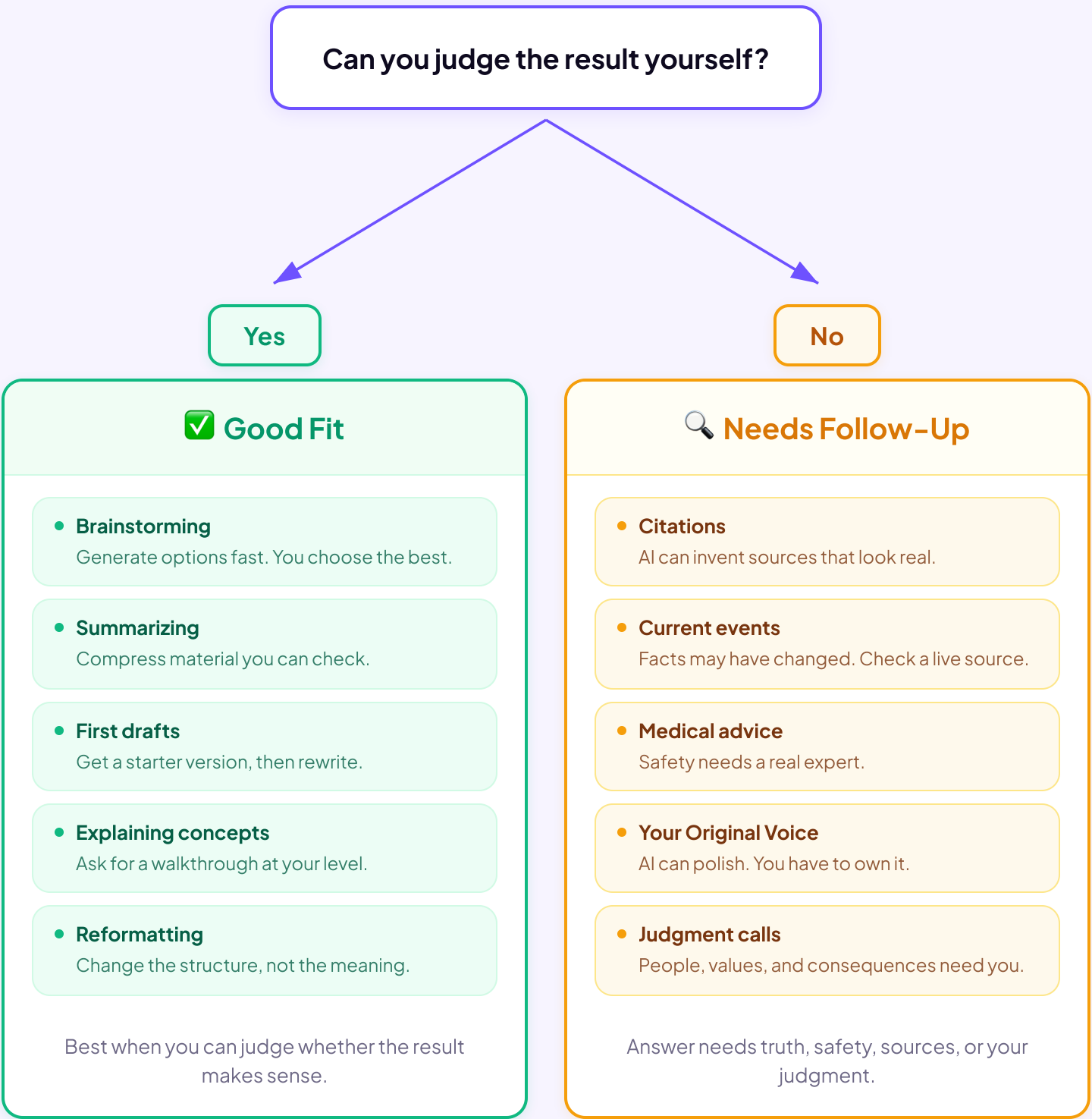
IT’S YOURS, OR IT NEEDS A PERSON

- The task needs your own voice or judgment.
- Someone is in real danger and needs a person, now.

FOR EVERYTHING ELSE, SET THE DIAL

Everything else is fair game. From here, the question becomes how much follow-up the answer needs. Start by naming the **type of task** you are asking AI to do. Some task types are easy to judge on your own and need little follow-up. Other task types almost always need follow-up because the answer has to be true, current, safe, sourced, or genuinely yours.

How Much to Check



Good Fit doesn’t mean ready to use. It means the task matches AI’s strengths and you can judge the result. The final call is still yours.

Now your turn. Below are prompts you might type. Make the call on each: is it a Good Fit, or does it Need Follow-Up?

🔑 **The real question isn’t “Can AI do this?”** It’s “What do I need to check before I use it?” That’s the move judgment makes.

TRY IT

Knowing how much to check an answer is the real skill. For each prompt, decide whether it’s a Good Fit or Needs Follow-Up.